

Stream of Consciousness -- Dream Theater

Train of Thought, 2003. Instrumental. ~160 BPM, est. (double-time and meter shifts throughout).

John Myung's part here is dense, fast, and technical -- this is the instrumental centerpiece of the album, built around a long dynamic arc from a moody, restrained intro/mid-section into full-band unison blast sections.

GP-5 only, P/J bass, no pedalboard.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 30. Fast technical picking at this gain level throws off noise between notes -- keeps the low end tight.

PRE -- Micro Boost, on CTL.

Gain: 40 when engaged.

Off for the intro/moody passages, on for the full-band blast sections -- pushes harder into the NAM's front end for extra grit and volume when the whole band hits.

DST -- Bass OD, on CTL (same footswitch as PRE and RVB).

Gain: 45, Blend: 60, VOL: 60, Bass: 55, Treble: 50.

Off at rest. Stacked with the Micro Boost for the blast sections -- adds real grind on top of the amp's own breakup, so the loud sections hit noticeably harder than just "louder," not just a volume bump.

AMP/CAB -- NAM SnapTone, slot 56: ProgSVT (always on)

- Built from the `SVT CLEAN PUSHED (SVT-CL)` NAM and the Mesa215 IR, combined into one snaptone.
- Real Ampeg SVT-CL on the clean-pushed setting, into the Mesa215 2x15 IR.
- Myung's Mesa tone again. Pushed SVT into a Mesa 2x15 is the closest combo.
- Gain: 52, VOL: 50, Bass: 55, Middle: 62, Treble: 55
- Gain 52: a little over default. This part wants more push than the other ProgSVT patches.
- Bass 55: Enough low end to anchor the riff without getting flabby at speed.
- Middle 62: Pushed hard. This is what lets the part cut through a wall of guitar.
- Treble 55: Present enough for pick/finger attack to read clearly on fast runs.
- VOL 50: the default. Trim here if the patch jumps in level against your others.
- Same in both CTL states. AMP and CAB are off in the `.prst`, so nothing stacks on the capture. The N->S block calls slot 56 directly.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, always on.

50Hz: +3, 120Hz: +2, 400Hz: -3, 800Hz: 0, 4.5kHz: +5, VOL: 55.

Small low-end reinforcement, a cut around 400Hz to keep the pushed SVT from getting boxy under the guitars, and a push at 4.5kHz so fast fingerstyle runs stay articulate instead of blurring together.

MOD -- off. No modulation -- this part needs to read as precise and dry, not smeared.

DLY -- off. Straight, driving part. No delay.

RVB -- Room, on CTL (same footswitch as PRE and DST).

Mix: 22, Decay: 35, Trail: true.

Off for the intro/moody sections -- dry and upfront. On for the blast sections, alongside the boost and drive -- gives the loud unison hits a little more size and glue without turning them into a wash.

CTL footswitch

Three modules on CTL: PRE (Micro Boost), DST (Bass OD), RVB (Room) -- all tied to the same footswitch, at the 3-module max.

- **CTL off** -- intro/moody-section sound. Dry, tight, just the NAM's own grit. This is the resting state the patch loads into.
- **CTL on** -- full-band blast-section sound. Boosted front end, extra drive stacked on, touch of room reverb -- same core tone, hits considerably harder and bigger.

Engage CTL going into the unison blast sections, back off for the quieter/moody instrumental passages. One footswitch, one clean two-state split for a song that lives and dies on that dynamic contrast.